



RIGHTSIZE. RIGHT SUPPORT. **RIGHT** *for* **STUDENTS.**

A family guide to the proposed school changes

Every school is a community. A school change can affect friendships, routines, programs, and a family's sense of belonging. This guide explains what is proposed and why.

Scenarios A and B are proposals, not final decisions. "No changes proposed" means these options do not include a change for that school.

Each school has a snapshot and a box explaining the reasons for the proposal. The next page shows enrollment estimates, programs, student groups, and maps. Estimates cover 2027-28 through 2031-32. They are not current student counts.

The possible benefits are goals. A larger school does not automatically get a full-time librarian, certain staff, or specific programs. Those details depend on the district's staffing rules, budget, and plans for making the changes.

A school or program move does not determine where an individual student receiving special education services will go. Families and school teams would need to plan each student's services and support.

The school details, numbers, and maps come from PPS school profiles. This guide explains that information in simpler language.

Words you may see in this guide

No changes

What is expected if the district keeps the current schools and programs.

Option A / Option B

The two scenarios. "A and B" means the same information applies to both.

School boundary

The area used to assign students to a neighborhood school based on where they live.

School communities joining

Students from two or more schools would come together. The proposal says which school building would close.

Programs joining

A program would come together at one school or move to another school.

DLI

Dual Language Immersion: learning in English and another language.

School size goal

More than 360 students for K-5 schools; more than 500 for K-8 or middle schools; more than 1,100 for high schools. These are planning goals, not ratings of school quality.

Space use goal

The district aims to use 70%-100% of a school's available room for students. A "No" can mean the school is below or above that range.

Title I

Federal money that supports schools serving students from low-income households. The guide shows the expected designation.

IEP

An Individualized Education Program: a written plan for a student's special education services and support.

Choice program

A program with a special focus, such as arts or science. It may serve families beyond a neighborhood school boundary.

Student groups

Groups can overlap. Do not add the percentages together.

**You may notice slight differences in student numbers and/or demographics in schools that don't experience change because a focus option school has changed and we assume that students return to their neighborhood school.*

MARKHAM

School proposal | Options A and B

SCHOOL SNAPSHOT	DETAILS
Current program	K-5 neighborhood
Expected enrollment with no changes	312 in 2027-28; 347 in 2031-32
District school size goal	More than 360 students
Students living within 1 mile	47.2%
Building notes	School space is described below.

WHY IS PPS CONSIDERING THIS?

Filling open classroom space: Absorbing 70% of the Stephenson boundary increases Markham’s classroom use above 90% and helps keep student numbers steadily above 500 students.

This is a proposal, not a final decision.

What is being proposed?

Markham would remain open as a neighborhood K-5 school.
Markham would expand its boundary to welcome 70% of the students from the closing Stephenson K-5 school.
Markham would welcome the K-2 Intensive Skills Classroom from Maplewood (uniting it with the 3-5 classroom).

What could students gain?

Combined special education services: Brings K-5 Intensive Skills Special Education classrooms together under one roof. Stable funding and programs: Strong student numbers ensure stable enrollment over time.

What else was considered?

Room for more students: Both Markham and Capitol Hill offer more room than Stephenson to comfortably house incoming students.

What about special education?

The Intensive Skills Classroom currently located at Maplewood Elementary School will return to Markham Elementary School. To ensure a seamless transition, school and district leaders will conduct site walk-throughs to evaluate programmatic readiness, space, transportation, and ADA accessibility. Special education administrators will work closely with school principals to ensure every site is prepared to meet student IEP requirements.

MARKHAM

ENROLLMENT, PROGRAMS & MAPS

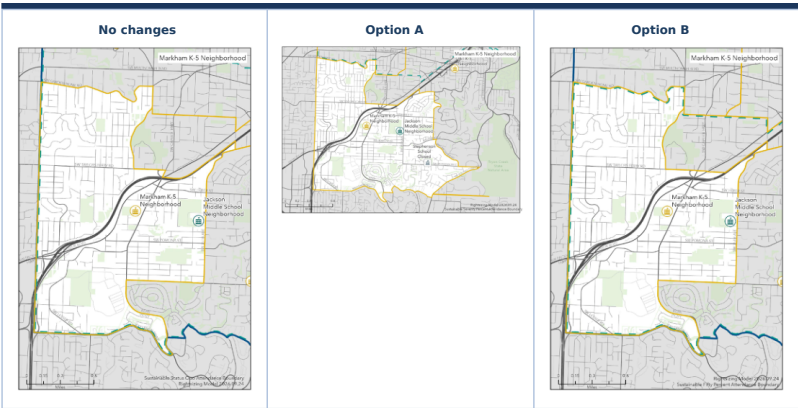
How many students are expected?

School year	2027-28	2028-29	2029-30	2030-31	2031-32
No changes	312	340	347	353	347
Option A	519	543	543	554	549
Option B	312	340	347	353	347

Programs, school size & nearby families

Measure	No changes	Option A	Option B
Type of change	No changes	School boundary change	No changes proposed
Meets school size goal?	No	Yes	No
Meets space use goal?	No	Yes	No
Students living within 1 mile	47.2%	29.5%	47.2%
Grades and programs	K-5 neighborhood	K-5 neighborhood	K-5 neighborhood

Where would the school boundary be?



Who would the school serve?

Option	Poverty	Special education	Multilingual services	Underserved racial groups	Title I
No changes	38.3%	13.9%	15.3%	40.1%	Yes
Option A	25.7%	15.1%	10.6%	29.9%	No
Option B*	34.9%	14.4%	14.2%	37.8%	Yes